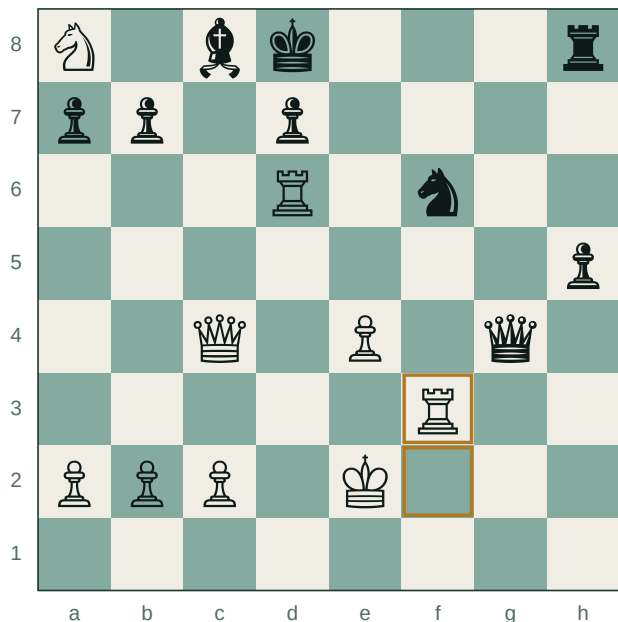


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 28

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Rf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Qg2+ 29. Rf2 Qxe4+ 30. Qxe4 Nxe4

28...Qg2+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From g2 it attacks king on e2 and rook on f3. Recorded reply: **29.Rf2**.

29...Qxe4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From e4 it attacks king on e2 and queen on c4. Recorded reply: **30.Qxe4**.

30...Nxe4 The knight captures the queen on e4. From e4 it attacks rook on f2 and rook on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on e2. Absolute pin: rook on f3.